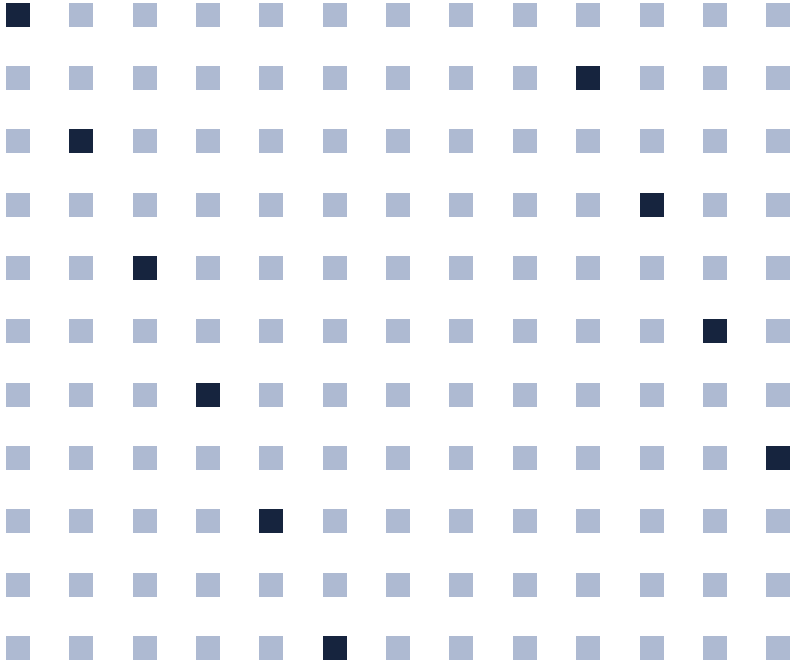
ATHENA ELECTION OBSERVATORY | APEA

ONDO 2024

FORENSIC POST-ELECTION AUDIT

Governorship election

Conducted under the Athena Post-Election Audit Framework (APAF)



3,933 polling units · 203 wards · 18 LGAs · 1 state declaration

BVAS → EC8A → EC8B → EC8C → EC8D

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THE ANSWER

What did we find?

90.1%

of assessable polling units complied with APEA's forensic integrity tests

3,496 of 3,880 assessable polling units, under published APAF rules.

APEA ELECTION INTEGRITY ASSESSMENT

Adequate Integrity — Improvement Required

Assessed on incidence, severity, type, concentration and evidence quality. Outcome materiality is reported separately.

3,933	3,880	3,496	384	53
Polling units audited	**Assessable**	**Compliant**	**Non-compliant**	**Excluded**
100% coverage	98.7% of all PUs	90.1% of assessable PUs	9.9% of assessable PUs	1.3% of all PUs

APEA is an electoral integrity audit, not a judicial determination. Compliance classifications are analytical findings under published APAF rules.

WHAT DOES THAT MEAN?

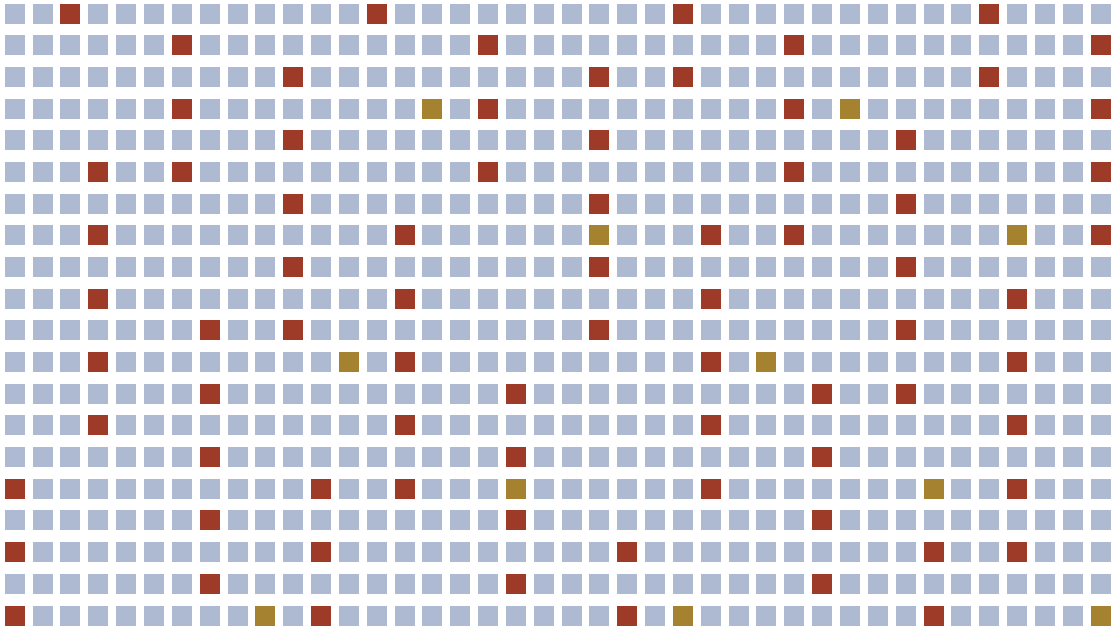
Most polling units passed. The failures remained — and were not evenly spread.

3,496 Compliant polling units

384 Non-compliant (9.9% of assessable)

53 Excluded — no usable result

Compliance is high overall, but the non-compliant polling units are not scattered evenly: a handful of LGAs — led by Ondo West — carry most of them. The next slide shows where.



schematic · one marker ≈ 5 polling units · shading = compliance class · not geographic

OUTCOME MATERIALITY

Did the identified problems approach the declared outcome?

+248,936

Declared winning margin · APC 366,781 vs PDP 117,845

Even under the harshest stress test — APC's 119,031 votes in those polling units handed to PDP — APC still leads by 10,874. On the clean base alone APC leads 244,846 to 80,853. APC also cleared the 25% spread in 18 / 18 LGAs (12 required).

167,803

Votes outside the clean evidence base, in 1,053 polling units



18 / 18

LGAs where APC cleared the 25% spread (12 required)

"The defects are material to institutional integrity and public confidence — they are not material to who won."

WHERE WERE THE PROBLEMS?

Non-compliance was concentrated: Ondo West alone held 20.3% of it.

78 / 384

non-compliant polling units in Ondo West

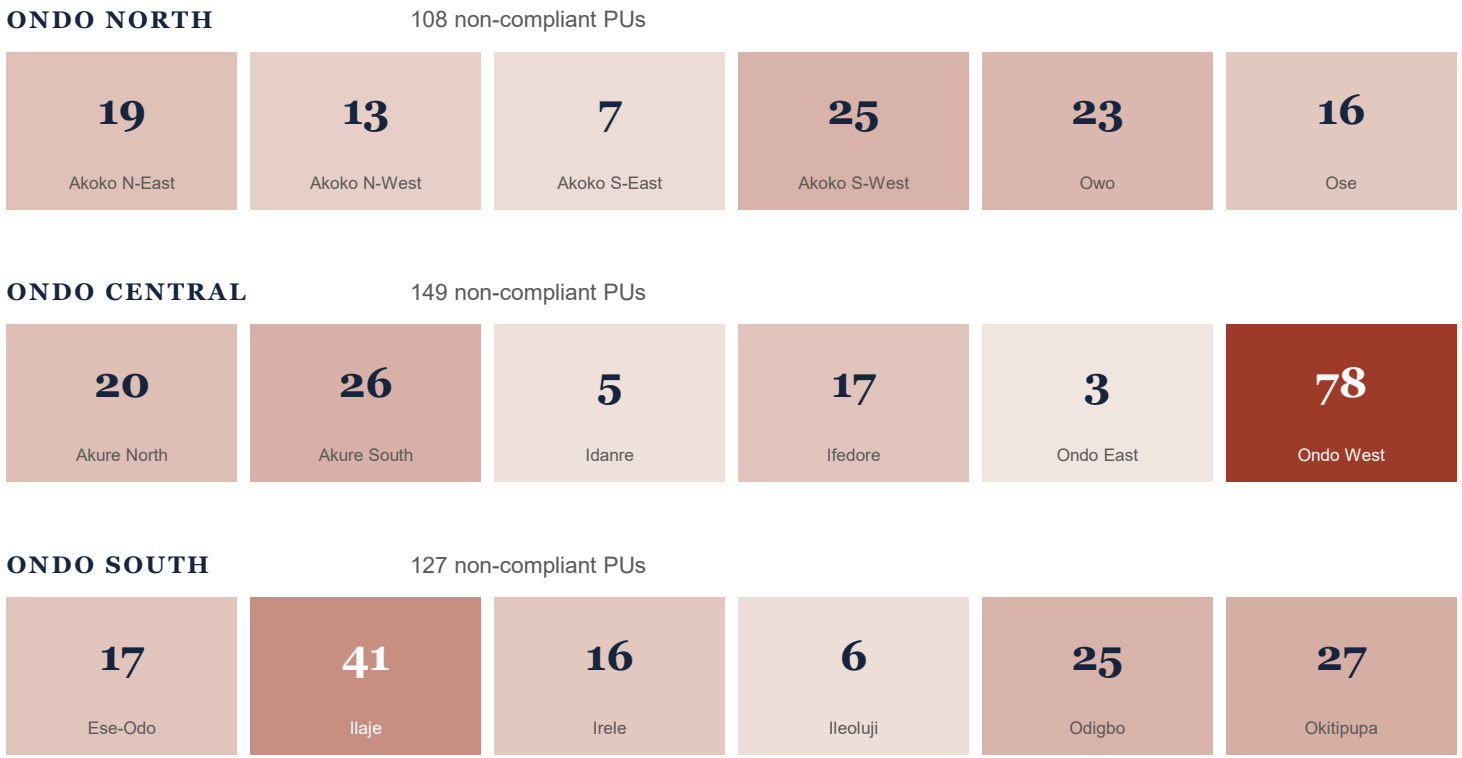
20.3% of all non-compliance

146 / 384

in the top three LGAs

38.0% — Ondo West 78, Ilaje 41, Okitipupa 27

A local failure is not the whole election; a small statewide rate does not erase where the failures sit.



Schematic tile grid grouped by senatorial zone; not to scale. Shading = number of non-compliant polling units. Counts, not rates — LGAs differ in size.

HOW DID THE ELECTION PERFORM?

Four dimensions, each with one principal finding — and no invented score.

01

Technology & Evidence Integrity

99.4%

results carried a BVAS record

- 3,910 / 3,933 EC8B uploaded to IReV
- 24 EC8A results without a BVAS record
- BVAS is the fixed accreditation anchor

02

Polling-Unit Compliance

90.1%

3,496 / 3,880 compliant

- 384 non-compliant (±5 band)
- 759 over-voted at EC8A
- Concentrated, not evenly spread

03

Collation Integrity

33 / 203

wards fail EC8B → EC8C

- All 18 LGA totals still reconcile
- 165 clean-base party alterations
- Net small, gross movement large

04

Outcome Materiality

67.4%

defects as a share of the margin

- Margin not approached (167,803 < 248,936)
- APC still leads under the stress test
- Integrity and outcome kept separate

THE SCALE OF THE AUDIT

We did not sample the election. We reconstructed it.

Every one of Ondo's 3,933 polling units was carried through the full chain — BVAS accreditation, EC8A, EC8B, EC8C and EC8D — and reconciled at each link. The audit rests on a single locked dataset of INEC's own records, not a sample.

3,933

polling units

every PU tested

203

wards

EC8B collation

18

LGAs

EC8C collation

1

state declaration

EC8D

Every polling unit · the full BVAS → EC8D chain · one locked, reproducible dataset

FOUR QUESTIONS, ANSWERED FROM INEC'S OWN RECORDS

Discrepancies in the chain, totals that reconcile — and a margin the discrepancies do not approach.

18 / 18

Do the declared totals reconcile through the chain?

All 18 LGA total-vote figures reconcile to the declaration (APC 366,781, 73.8% of valid votes, margin 248,936). Party-level reconciliation holds in 15 / 18 LGAs.

759 → 248

Was there statutory over-voting?

759 of 3,933 PUs (19.3%) exceeded BVAS accreditation at EC8A; 248 remained over-voted at EC8B (s.51(2), zero tolerance).

33 / 203

Did the collation chain preserve polling-unit results?

33 wards (16.3%) fail EC8B → EC8C total reconciliation; on the clean base, 165 PUs show party-vote change with no documented basis.

67.4%

Do the identified discrepancies approach the declared margin?

The 167,803 votes outside the clean evidence base equal 67.4% of the 248,936 margin — they do not approach it; APC would still lead even if all its votes there moved to PDP.

THE EVIDENCE CHAIN

A declaration can balance perfectly while the discrepancies are already inside it.



Each level is built from the one before it. A figure can be corrected at one link and altered at another, so the final EC8D can reconcile to the EC8C beneath it while polling-unit results were already changed far below. All 18 LGA totals reconcile to the declaration — yet 33 of 203 wards do not reconcile from EC8B to EC8C.

Reconciliation at the top is necessary, not sufficient. APEA follows the chain link by link, with BVAS as the fixed anchor.

THE CHAIN IN ACTION

Net movement was small. The movement underneath was not.

PARTY	EC8A	EC8B	EC8D declared	Net EC8A→EC8B
APC	392,882	364,648	366,781	**-28,234**
PDP	118,857	117,442	117,845	**-1,415**
ADC	4,197	4,573	—	**+376**

APC's total fell 28,234 between the polling-unit forms and ward collation — the correction of 554 over-voted polling units back within accreditation — then settled at 366,781 on declaration. The net change up the chain is small; the gross movement inside it is large.

COLLATION INTEGRITY · FINDING 1

33 of 203 wards did not reconcile from EC8B to EC8C.

93,762 → 93,990

total votes in the 33 non-reconciling wards: EC8B PU-sum → EC8C. The net change is only +228 — yet 6,300 votes move in gross across those wards.

33

of 203 wards (16.3%)

WHAT THE PATTERN SHOWS

22 wards match neither EC8A nor EC8B at EC8C

9 wards under-record at EC8B

2 wards over-record at EC8B

Every one of the 18 LGA totals still reconciles to the declaration — the ward-level breaks are absorbed before EC8D.

THE FIVE PILLARS

Accreditation and transmission held up. Collation did not hold as well.



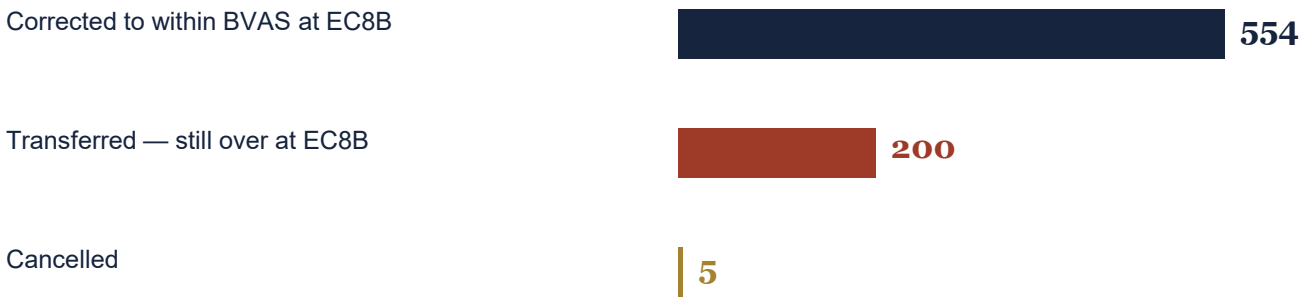
Pillar 2 (ballot accounting) is not assessable — Ondo's forms carry no spoilt or unused-ballot columns. Pillars 1 and 3 clear comfortably; the movement sits in computation and the result-correction tier.

PILLAR 5 · LEGAL OVER-VOTING

Most EC8A over-voting was reconciled by EC8B — and part of it was carried through.

759

polling units over BVAS at EC8A · 59,232 excess votes



AT WARD COLLATION, 248 POLLING UNITS REMAIN OVER BVAS

200 transferred over-voting (carried through)

33 unexplained inflation (clean at EC8A)

15 over by one to five votes

Of 759 polling units over-voted at EC8A, 73% were corrected back within accreditation by EC8B; 200 carried the over-vote through unchanged, and 33 clean units became over-voted only at collation.

Party figures moved on polling units that were never over-voted.

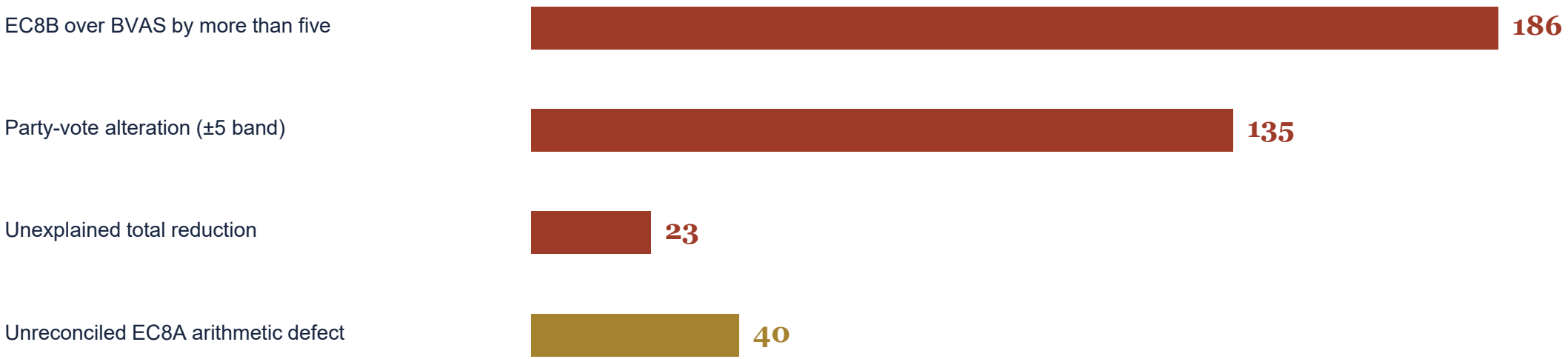
165

clean-base polling units where a party's figure changed between EC8A and EC8B by more than five votes — units that were within BVAS and carry no legitimate reason to move.

A correction has a documented basis; an over-vote has an arithmetic one. A change on a clean polling unit has neither — which is why these are isolated as a distinct finding and tested for direction (see Appendix E1).

WHERE COMPLIANCE BREAKS

The 384 were driven by changes in composition, not raw over-voting — and Ondo West led.



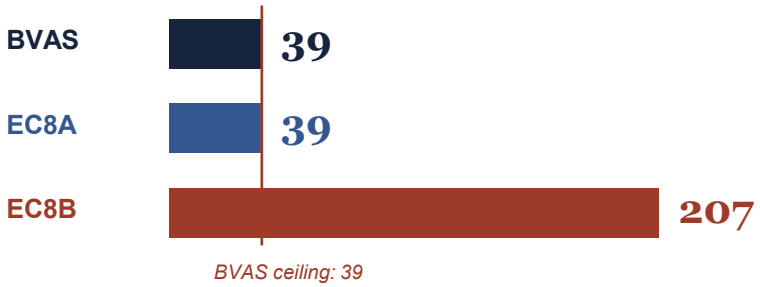
Each non-compliant polling unit is classified by its first trigger. Over-voting at collation is only one route in — party-vote alteration on otherwise-clean units is nearly as large, and together they, not raw over-voting, drive the 384. Ondo West alone holds 78 of them.

FORENSIC CASES

Three cases, traced form by form.

UNEXPLAINED INFLATION · 33 PUs · +3,124 VOTES

Faloye II, Akure North



APC 24 → 135, PDP 12 → 56 between EC8A and EC8B. Clean at EC8A; the EC8B total of 207 runs far over BVAS.

33

polling units clean at EC8A but over BVAS at EC8B — the inflation appears only at collation, adding 3,124 votes above BVAS.

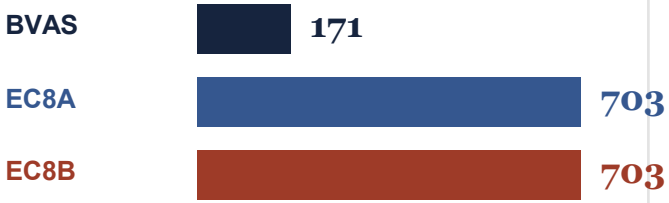
TRANSFERRED OVER-VOTING

200

PUs · 9,480 excess votes

Over-voted at EC8A and still over BVAS at EC8B.

ETI OSE (AKOKO SOUTH EAST)



PARTY-VOTE ALTERATION

165

PUs altered beyond ±5

Party figures changed between EC8A and EC8B.

AGBA IV (AKOKO SOUTH WEST)



ADP falls 150 → 0 as APC rises 0 → 241; the total reconciles at 275.

See the evidence yourself.

BVAS	EC8A	EC8B
39	→ 39	→ 207

APC 24 → 135 between EC8A and EC8B (PDP 12 → 56). The EC8B total of 207 exceeds the BVAS accreditation of 39.

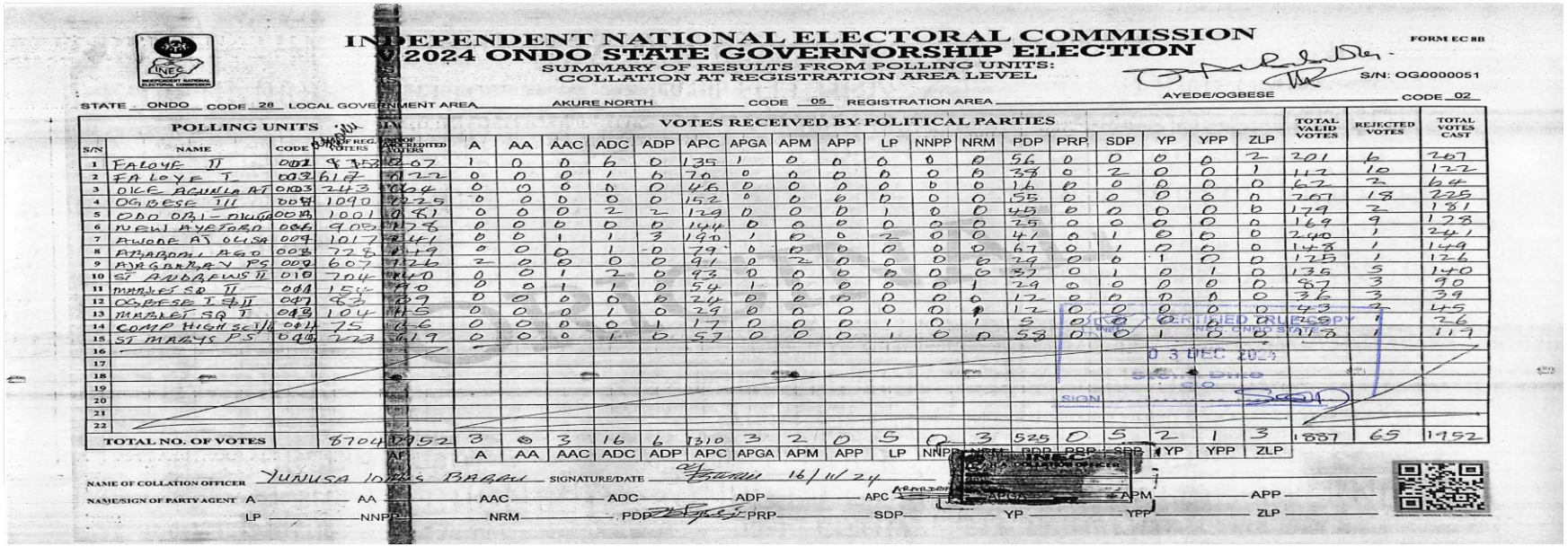
EC8B rewrites accreditation: the collation form records 207 accredited voters against the BVAS figure of 39 — a fivefold inflation. Both forms otherwise add up internally.

EC8A · POLLING UNIT



EC8B · WARD COLLATION

PU code: 28-05-02-012



Every figure on this page can be checked against the forms above.

AUDIT EVIDENCE COVERAGE

Every record we expected — and what we did and did not obtain.

RECORD	EXPECTED	OBTAINED	NOTE
BVAS accreditation	3,933	**3,933**	Complete — the accreditation baseline.
EC8A polling-unit result	3,933	**3,845**	88 without a result (81 still carry a BVAS record).
EC8B ward collation	3,993	**3,881**	All assessable polling units.
EC8C LGA collation	203	**203**	All wards aggregated.
EC8D state declaration	18	**18**	All LGA totals reconcile to the declaration.
Ballot accounting columns	—	**0**	Not collated on Ondo's forms — Pillar 2 not assessable.

RECOMMENDATIONS

Make every change between forms explainable, documented and auditable.

01	**Reconcile EC8B→EC8C ward by ward**	Require documented reconciliation where a ward total changes between collation levels.
02	**Correct over-voting at source, on the record**	Where a polling unit is corrected back within accreditation, hold and publish the correction basis.
03	**Preserve party figures on the clean base**	Flag any party-vote change on a unit that was never over-voted — it has no legitimate basis.
04	**Carry BVAS as the fixed accreditation anchor**	Tie every level to the BVAS record so accreditation cannot be rewritten upward at collation.
05	**Publish a reconcilable collation trail**	Make EC8A→EC8D records traceable and machine-readable for independent reconstruction.

CLOSING

EVERY ELECTION LEAVES AN EVIDENCE TRAIL.

APEA follows it.

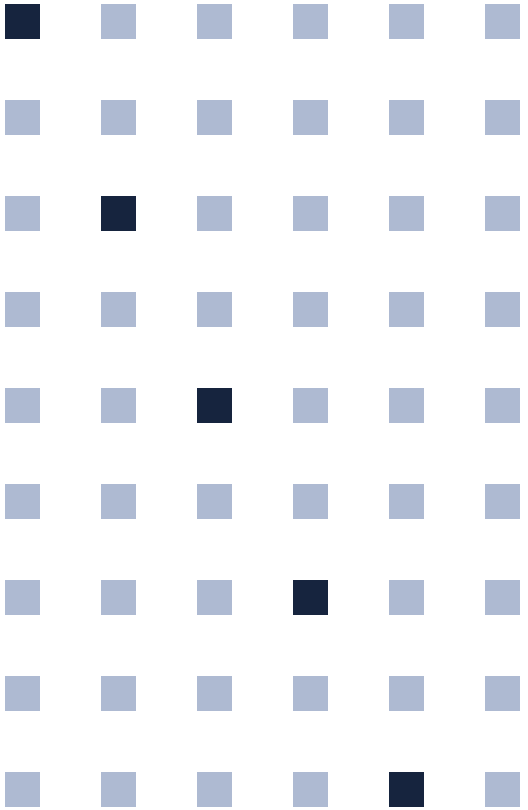
Reconstruct the result. Anchor it to BVAS. Separate the law from the forensics.

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LAYER 3

The Audit.

Definitions, methodology, the five-pillar detail and the per-LGA reconciliation behind every finding.



Standard of proof: what this audit is — and what it is not.

Scope of the finding	This report assesses what INEC's own forms — BVAS, EC8A, EC8B, EC8C and EC8D — can and cannot substantiate. It does not allege intent, coordination or criminal conduct by any person or party.
Standard of proof	Credit and criticism flow only from what is verifiable in the primary forms. A numerical fact (a figure changed between two forms) is reported as such; the administrative reason is reported only where a record supports it.
Statistical statements	Where a significance test is used, it states that a pattern is inconsistent with an equal-direction null at a stated level. It does not infer why a pattern occurred.
Absence of evidence	Where evidence is insufficient, the matter is marked not assessable. Absence of evidence is never treated as evidence of compliance.

Key terms.

Polling Unit (PU)	The base voting location — where every verdict is first formed. Ondo has 3,933.
BVAS	The electronic accreditation record; the independent ceiling for votes cast.
EC8A / EC8B	The polling-unit result (EC8A) and its ward collation (EC8B).
EC8C / EC8D	The LGA collation (EC8C) and the State declaration (EC8D).
Legal over-voting	Votes cast exceed accredited voters (s.51(2)). Zero tolerance — one excess vote is a failure.
±5 material band	A five-vote clerical tolerance for arithmetic, collation and compliance — never for the over-voting tests.
Dual verdict	Each PU carries two independent verdicts: a legal status and a forensic-integrity status.
Clean base	PUs not over-voted at EC8A — where any later change invites scrutiny.
Party-vote alteration	A party's figure changed between EC8A and EC8B beyond ±5, total preserved or not.
Compliant / Non-compliant	The forensic compliance verdict (P5.3), applying the ±5 band. Excluded PUs counted separately.

Methodology & statistical note.

Baseline	BVAS accreditation is the ceiling for votes cast (s.51(2), Electoral Act 2026). A result with zero or blank BVAS is treated as over-voted, not as not assessable.
Tolerances	Zero tolerance applies to legal over-voting at EC8A, to transferred over-voting and its resolution. The ±5 band applies to inflation, the P5.3 count, accreditation consistency, all Pillar 4 arithmetic and collation tests, and to reduction and party-vote magnitude.
Significance test	Exact two-sided binomial sign test on the direction of non-zero party changes on clean PUs carrying a party-vote alteration; ties within ±5 excluded; reported only where at least 10 PUs move; threshold adjusted for six parties (0.0083). Wording states inconsistency with an equal-direction null — never non-randomness or intent.
Reproducibility	Every figure traces to one locked control dataset; matching is by ward and LGA code, not by name.

Pillars 1–3: accreditation, ballot accounting and transmission.

PILLAR 1 · ACCREDITATION INTEGRITY



P1.1 BVAS = EC8A accreditation match, within ±5	**80.9%**	733 no-match
P1.2 EC8A = EC8B accreditation match, within ±5	**82.8%**	678 no-match
P1.3 BVAS = EC8B accreditation match, within ±5	**92.6%**	292 no-match

PILLAR 2 · BALLOT ACCOUNTING

Not assessable — Ondo's forms carry no spoilt or unused-ballot columns.

PILLAR 3 · TRANSMISSION & IReV INTEGRITY



P3.3 EC8A result carried a BVAS record result-without-BVAS flagged	**99.4%**	24 flagged
P3.3 EC8B result carried a BVAS record result-without-BVAS flagged	**99.4%**	23 flagged

Pillar 4: each form adds up; the figures do not all survive the climb.

WITHIN EACH FORM



P4.1 EC8A party sum = valid votes
arithmetic, ±5
97.6% — 92 defects

P4.2 EC8B party sum = valid votes
arithmetic, ±5
98.1% — 73 defects

P4.3 EC8B valid + rejected = total
arithmetic, ±5
99.4% — 25 defects

P4.4 EC8A → EC8B party reconciliation
clean-base party votes, ±5
96.3% — 140 altered

UP THE COLLATION CHAIN



P4.5 Ward total reconciles EC8B → EC8C
of 203 wards
83.7% — 33 discrepant

P4.6 Ward, every party reconciles
of 203 wards
68.5% — 64 discrepant

At LGA level every total reconciles EC8B → EC8D (P4.5); three LGAs carry a single-party discrepancy (P4.6).

Pillar 5: result-correction and compliance indicators.



P5.3 is the headline compliance verdict. The first non-compliance trigger: EC8B over BVAS by more than five (186), party-vote alteration (135), total reduction (23), unreconciled EC8A defect (40).

Only APC's direction of change departs from an equal-direction null.

An exact two-sided binomial sign test on the direction of party-vote alterations (changes within ±5 excluded; Bonferroni α = 0.0083).

PARTY	Gained	Lost	n	p (two-sided)	Verdict
APC	94	32	126	2.9×10^{-8}	Inconsistent with an equal-direction null
LP	0	48	48	7.1×10^{-15}	Inconsistent with an equal-direction null
PDP	64	52	116	0.31	Consistent with chance
ADC	6	8	14	0.79	Consistent with chance

APC gains exceed losses far beyond chance (net +4,593 votes across flagged units). LP's alterations are almost all losses. PDP and ADC are consistent with chance. A significant pattern is not a finding of intent — it flags where to look.

Visible, but not scored as failures.

149

polling units under-voted

Votes fall short of BVAS accreditation by more than five — 9,731 votes below the ceiling. An accreditation gap, not an over-vote; recorded, not scored against compliance.

53

excluded polling units

No usable EC8B result (45 accredited with no result; 8 with neither). Set aside from the compliance base rather than counted as a failure.

24

results without a BVAS record

An EC8A result recorded where BVAS shows no accreditation — flagged under transmission integrity (P3.3), carried as-is, not scored.

These are real and recorded, but APAF does not fold them into the compliance verdict — they are reported in their own right so the headline figure is neither inflated nor softened.

The 25% spread requirement was met in every LGA — six more than required.



18 / 18

LGAs cleared

Section 179 requires a governorship winner to poll at least 25% in two-thirds of LGAs — here, 12 of 18. APC cleared 25% in all 18, from 47.5% in Idanre to 84.7% in Ilaje. The spread holds on the clean base as well.

APC ≥ 25% in 18 of 18 LGAs · threshold: 12 · verdict: spread met

Institutional lessons: what this audit teaches beyond a single election.

01

A clean declaration is not a clean chain

A result that reconciles at EC8D can still rest on polling-unit figures that were changed far below.

02

Legal compliance and forensic integrity are separate

A unit can pass the over-voting test and still have had its party figures rewritten at collation.

03

The clean base is a critical integrity point

Changes on units never over-voted have no documented or arithmetic basis — the sharpest test of the chain.

04

BVAS anchoring strengthens evidence, not just accreditation

When accreditation can be rewritten upward at collation, every downstream figure loses its ceiling.

05

Reproducibility needs a traceable chain

One locked dataset, matched by code not name, is what lets another analyst rebuild the finding.

06

Materiality and integrity are different questions

A failure can be real, widespread and still not outcome-determinative — report both, conflate neither.

Recommendations to courts, parties, observers and partners.

COURTS & TRIBUNALS

· Assess disputed results across the BVAS → EC8A → EC8B → EC8C → EC8D chain, not a single collation level.

· Distinguish irregularity from electoral impact — require both the forensic and the materiality test.

POLITICAL PARTIES & AGENTS

· Strengthen scrutiny at collation centres, especially the EC8B → EC8C transition where most wards break.

· Keep independent ward records and reconcile party figures up the chain.

OBSERVERS & RESEARCHERS

· Extend observation and locked-record access to the full result-production chain, not just polling day.

· Distinguish compliance, non-compliance and unassessable evidence in reporting.

DEVELOPMENT PARTNERS

· Support reforms to result reconciliation, collation transparency and machine-readable publication.

· Fund independent post-election audits as standard, not exceptional.

Coverage & limits.

WHAT IT CAN SUPPORT

Everything derived from BVAS, EC8A, EC8B, EC8C and EC8D — accreditation consistency, over-voting, arithmetic, collation reconciliation and forensic-integrity classification, all reproducible from the locked dataset.

WHAT IT CANNOT

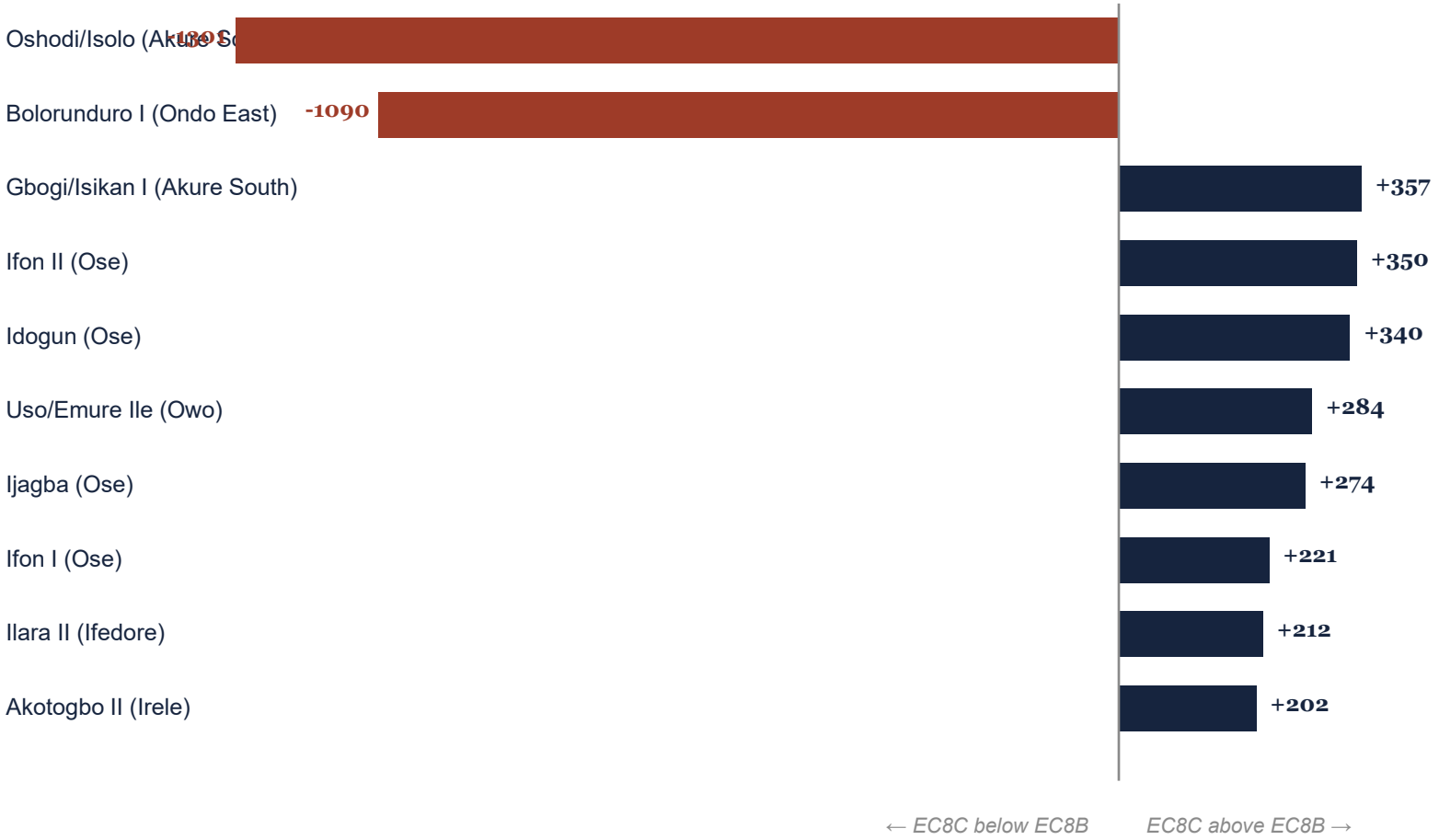
Ballot accounting (Pillar 2), because spoilt and unused-ballot columns were not collated; transmission and image usability (P3.1, P3.2), read from INEC IReV; and the administrative reason behind reconciled corrections where no record is held.

WHAT IT DOES NOT CLAIM

Intent, coordination or criminal conduct. The audit reports what the forms show and stops there.

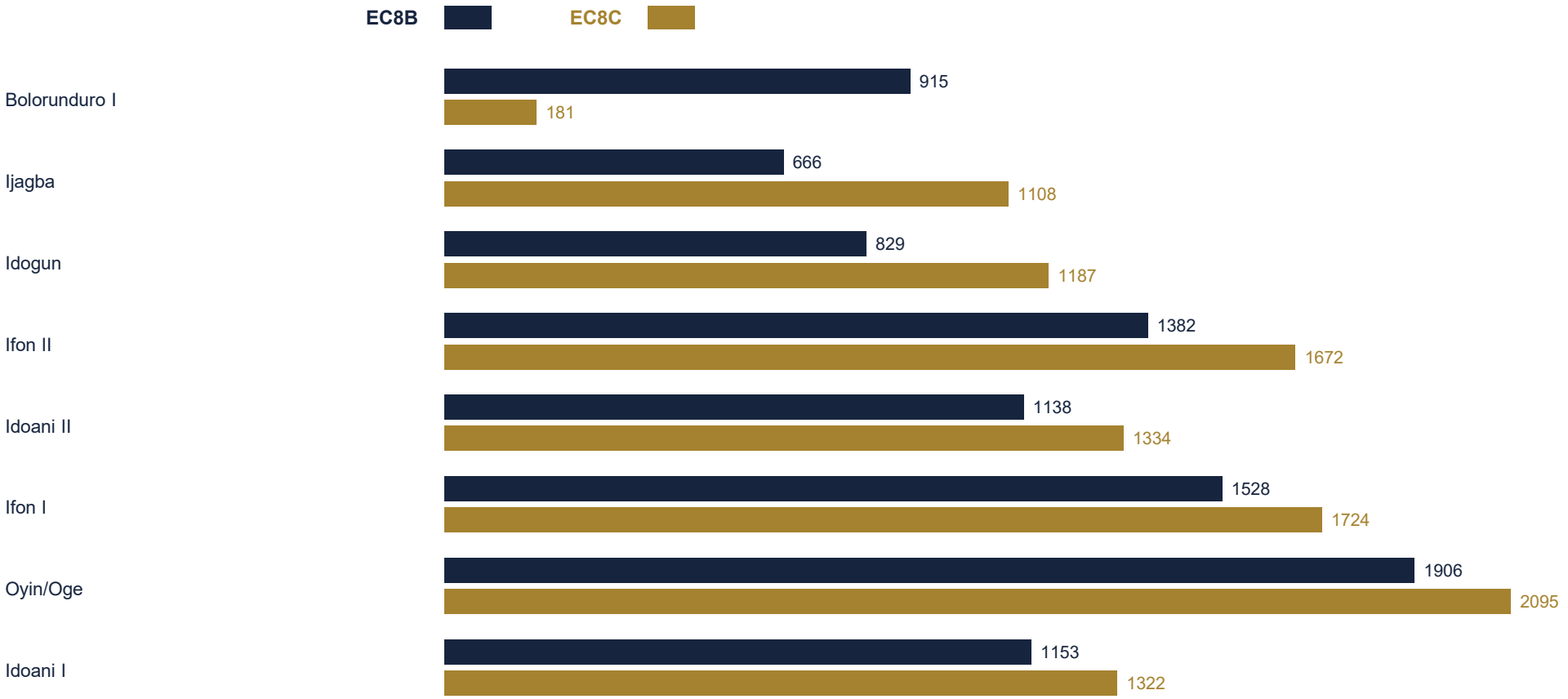
Where the non-reconciling wards sit.

The 33 wards that fail total reconciliation EC8B → EC8C, largest total gap first (EC8C minus EC8B PU-sum).



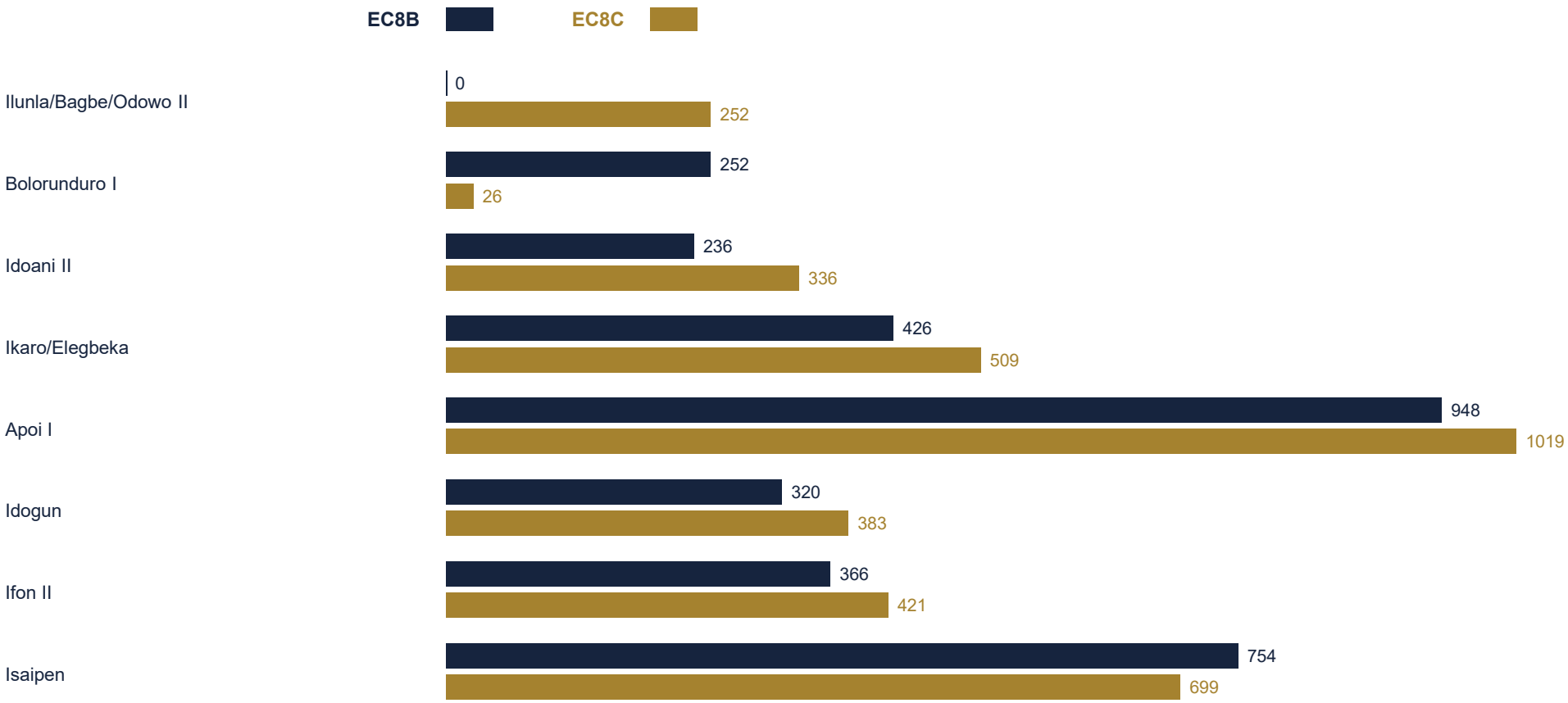
APC: where the figure changed between levels.

The 40 wards where APC's EC8C differs from its EC8B PU-sum by more than ±5. Matching bars reconcile; a gap is votes changed between collation levels.



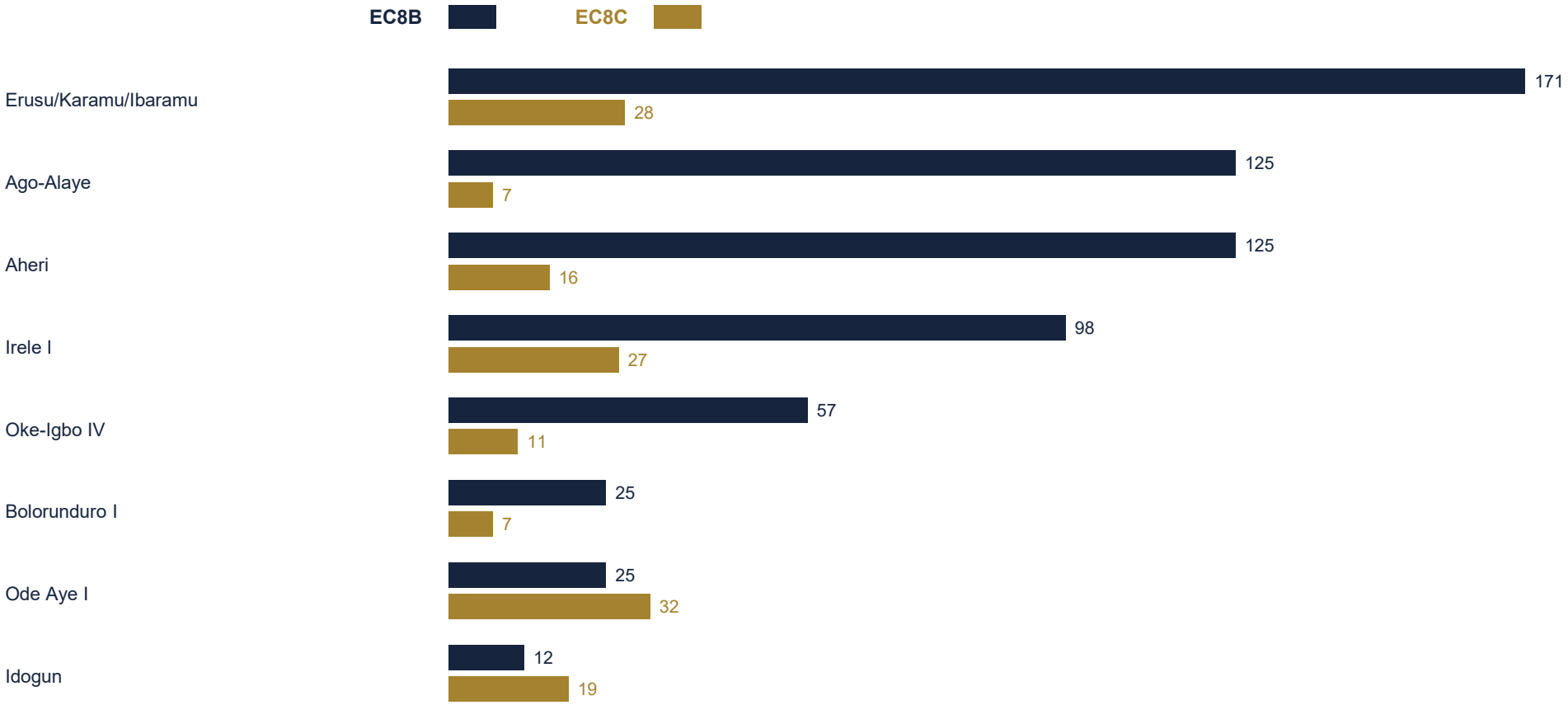
PDP: where the figure changed between levels.

The 34 wards where PDP's EC8C differs from its EC8B PU-sum by more than ±5. Matching bars reconcile; a gap is votes changed between collation levels.

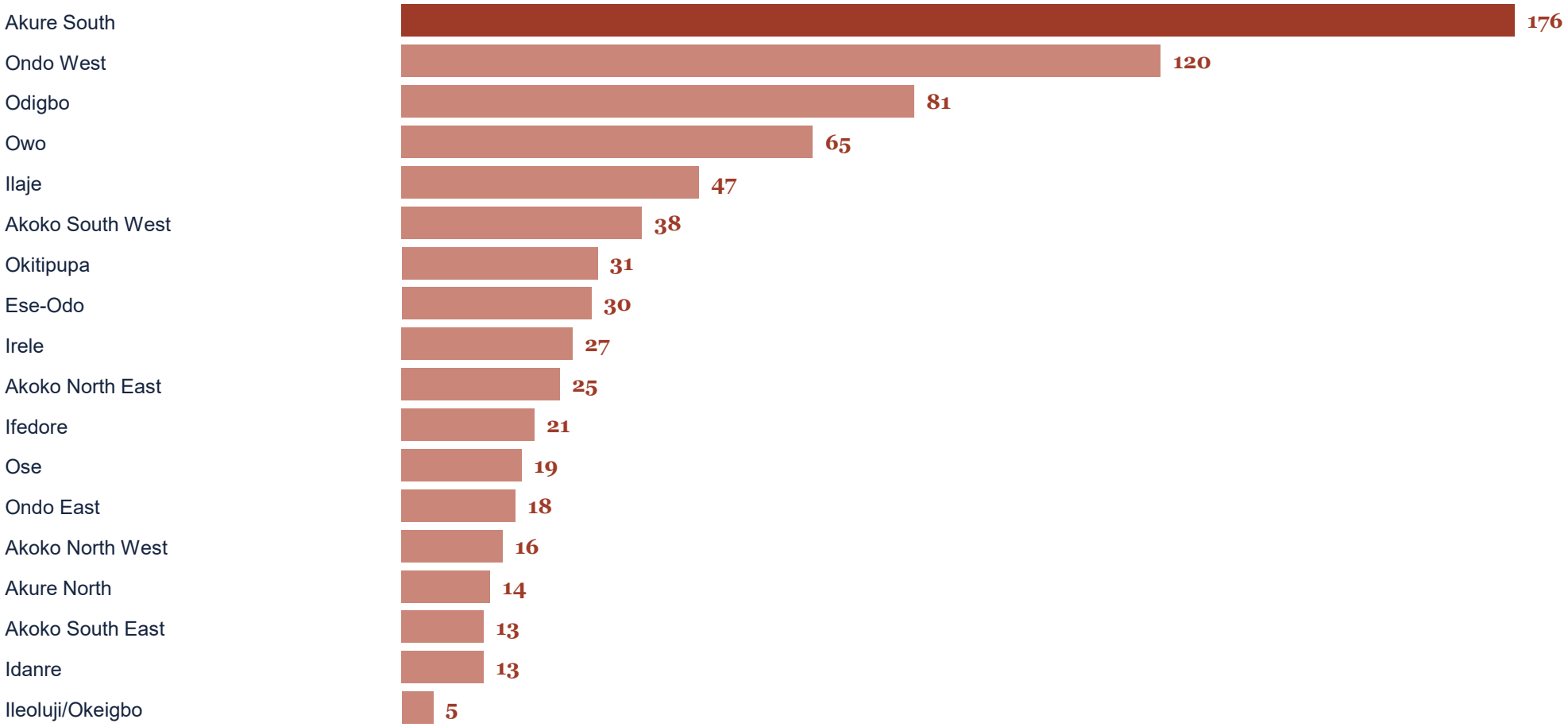


ADC: where the figure changed between levels.

The 11 wards where ADC's EC8C differs from its EC8B PU-sum by more than ±5. Matching bars reconcile; a gap is votes changed between collation levels.



Over-voting and party-vote alteration, by LGA.



Polling units over BVAS at EC8A, by LGA (759 in total). Akure South carries 176 — nearly one in four.

Non-compliant polling units by LGA (384 in total).

